FIN-009 · Personal finance

Event budget variance

Replace the sample figures before you rely on the result.

The sample is a 40-person celebration with a R45,000 plan. Food came in R1,500 over. Drinks came in R200 under. The contingency covered part of the food gap and the event still finished R1,850 over the original plan.

How to use the workbook

1. Write the plan before you pay deposits.
2. Enter actuals only when money has left the account.
3. Read the variance column. Positive is over plan.
4. If contingency is spent, stop adding lines until you cut something else.

Worked example

Venue, decor, and most of the contingency landed on plan.

- Food is the line that moved.
- The total plan is R45,000 and the total actual is R46,850.

A practical routine

- Put deposits in Actual as soon as they are paid.
- Ask for a revised quote in writing when a guest count changes.
- Do not hide an overrun by changing the original plan.

This workbook organises figures you type in. It is not financial, credit, insurance, or tax advice. Rates, fees, and laws change. A qualified adviser should review decisions that affect debt, tax, medical cover, or retirement.